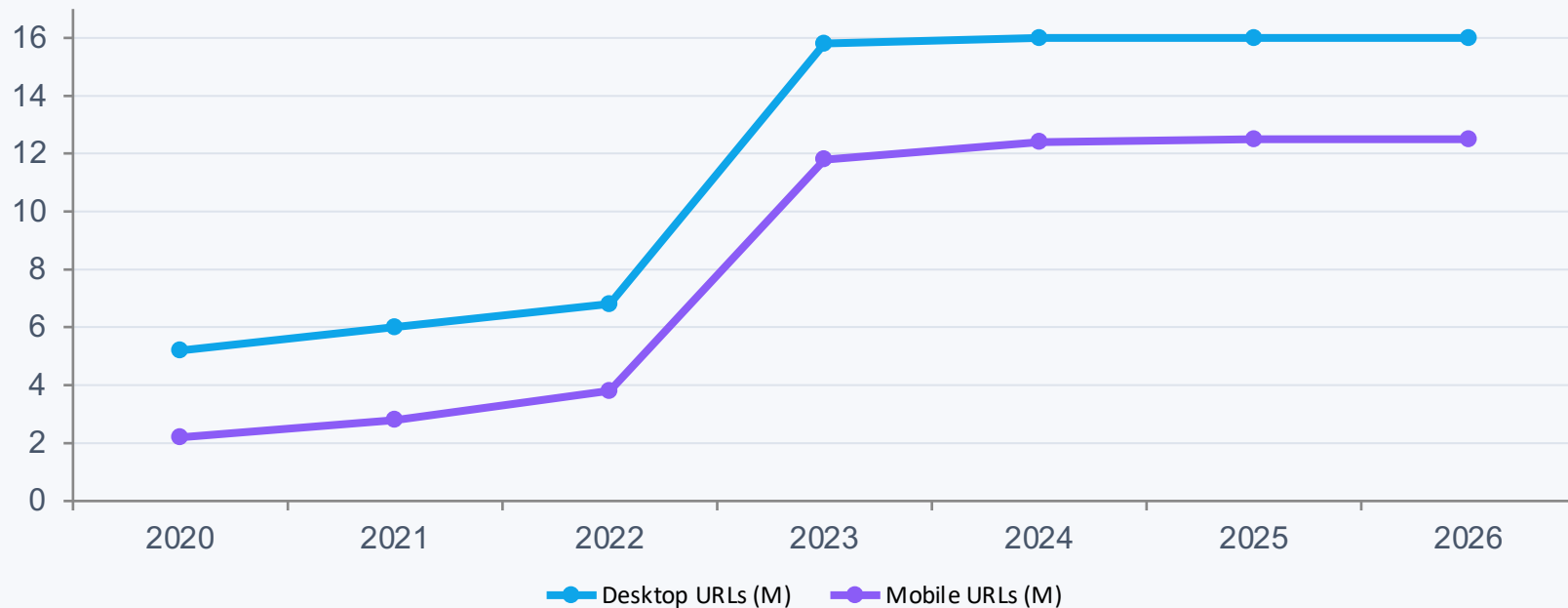


State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

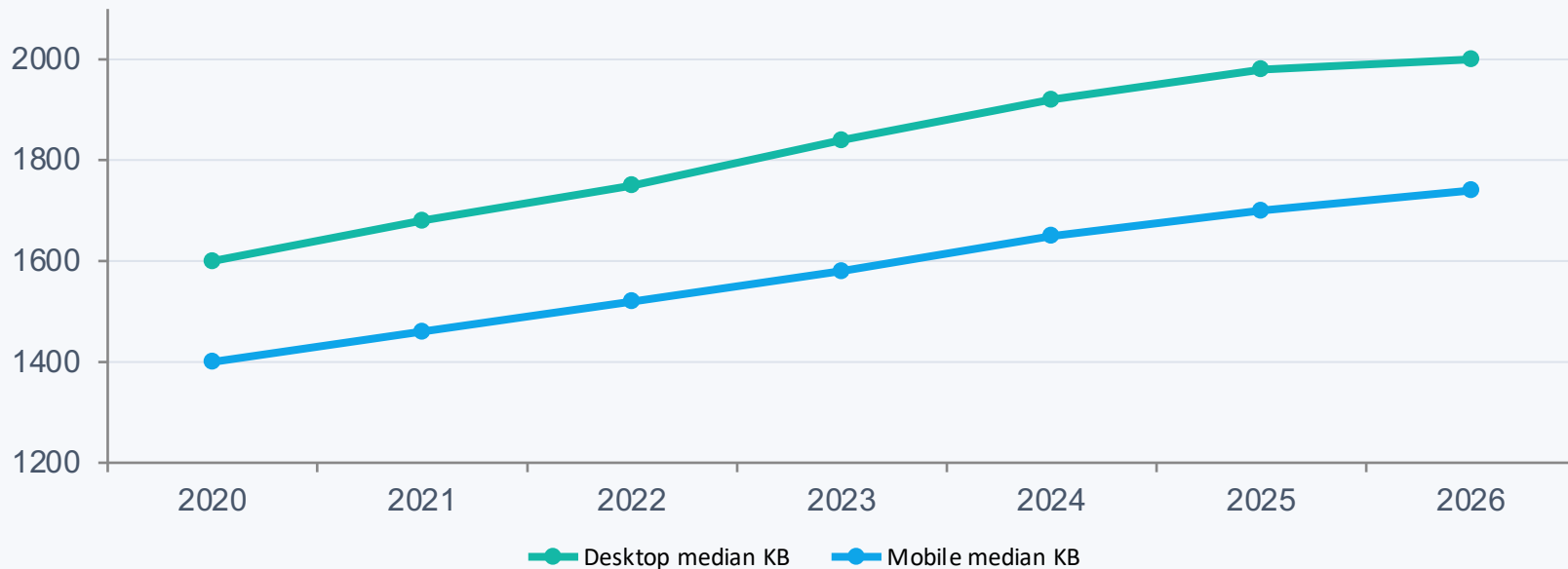
Data source: HTTP Archive monthly crawls | Time range: Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Desktop crawl volume increased ~3x (~5M → 16M); mobile rose to ~12.5M with a major jump around mid-2022.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



Median desktop transfer size rose by ~25% since 2020 (≈1,600 KB → ≈2,000 KB); mobile follows slightly lower.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Request Count (Latest)

76

Desktop

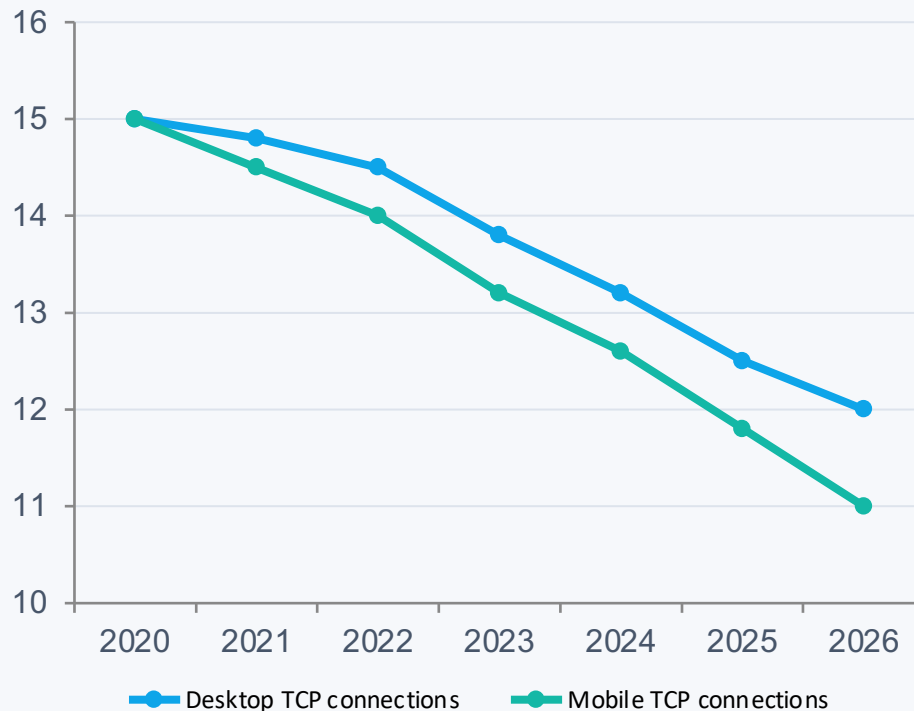
71

Mobile

Both are ~3% higher than 2020 levels.

Connection Efficiency

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 enables more requests with fewer TCP handshakes.



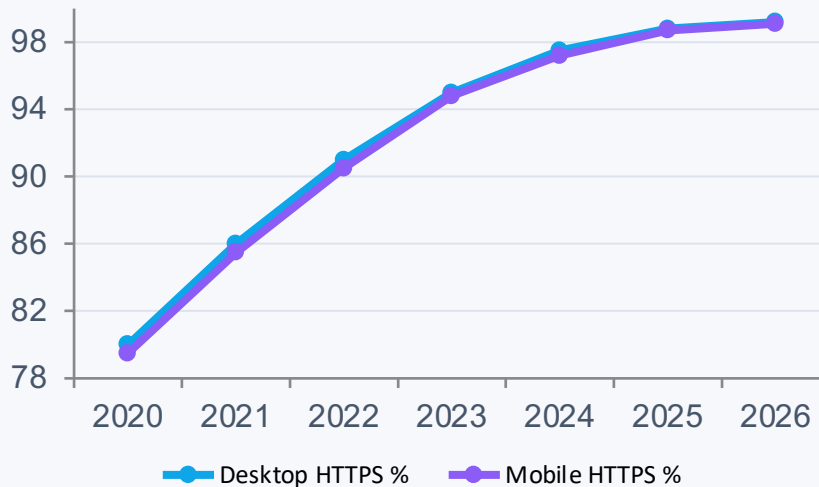
HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99%+

HTTPS share of requests

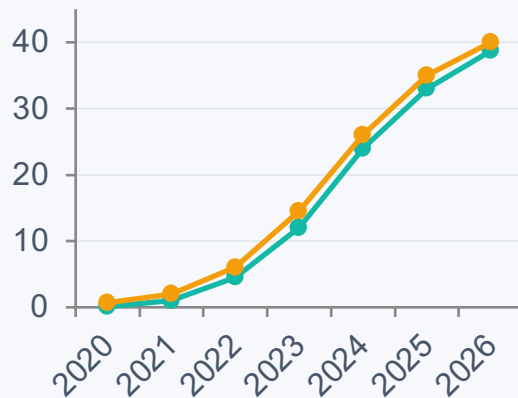
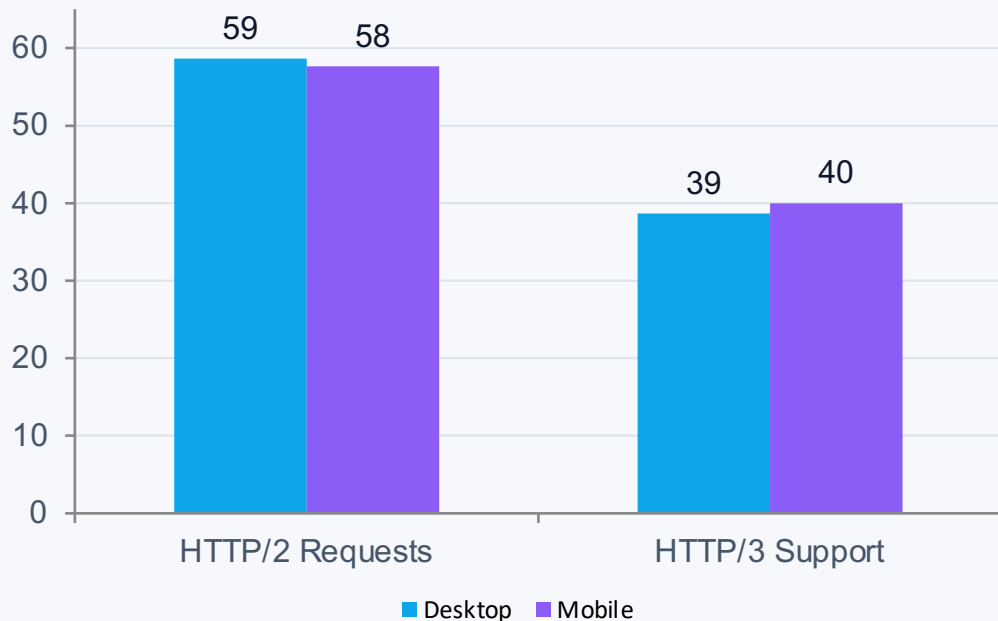
Desktop: 99.2%

Mobile: 99.1%



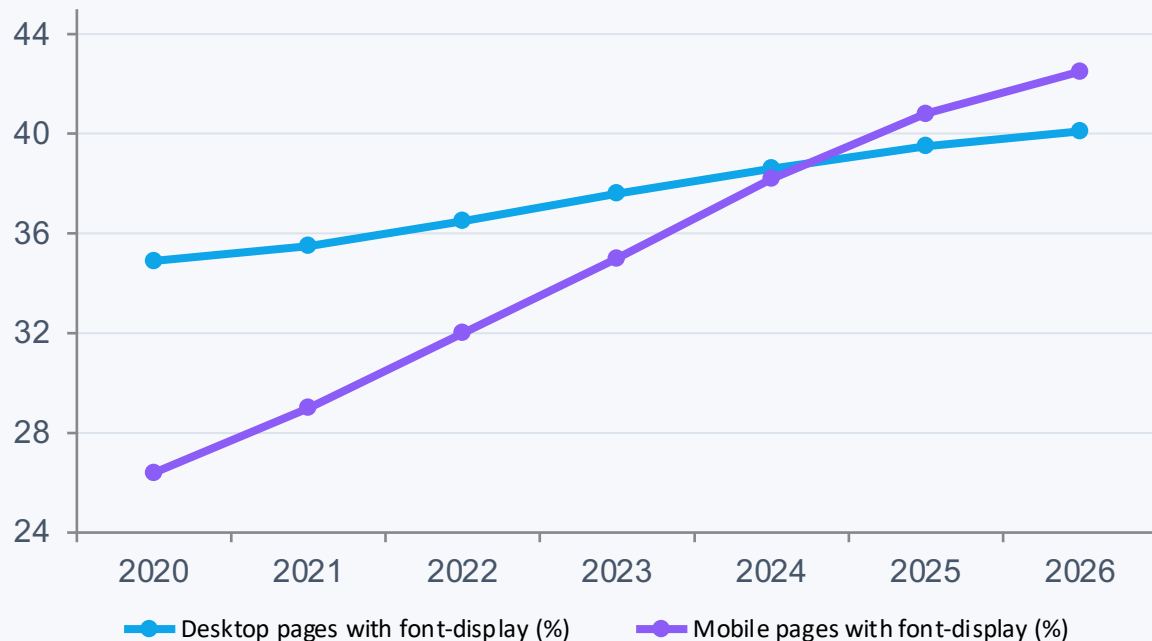
Plaintext HTTP is now effectively extinct in the modern crawl baseline.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%



Measurement caveat:
HTTP Archive tracks HTTP/3 support, not first-connection usage, since fresh Chrome starts on HTTP/2 before Alt-Svc discovery.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020



Current

40.1% D

42.5% M

Why it matters

font-display reduces FOIT, but over half of pages still lack coverage.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- Median desktop page weight climbed from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB (~25% increase).
- HTTPS now secures 99%+ of requests (99.2% desktop, 99.1% mobile).
- HTTP/3 support grew from near-zero to ~40%, the fastest protocol shift.
- Median TCP connections per page dropped (~15 → 12 desktop, ~15 → 11 mobile).
- font-display adoption improved, yet remains below half of all pages (~40–42%).

Call to action: Benchmark your own pages against these baselines and prioritize the largest variance first.